The Blue Stone:

Keep this in mind, God's adversary, thinks to Change Times and Law! – Remember Daniel 7:25

Revelation 17: 1-3… Now, you've already learned a lot more about the book of revelation than you think. What's a woman represent in Bible prophecy? A church…. What's a Beast represent in Bible prophecy? A Kingdom…. So what is depicted in Revelation 17 with the imagery of a Woman on a Beast?

Now, think about it… A woman on a Beast would be a *church* that's in control of *the State!* So here in Revelation 17, we have a Woman, an unfaithful Woman, a Harlot woman, on the back of a Beast, and so we have an unfaithful Church in charge of the State!

Consideration: In certain respects this beast resembles the great red dragon of ch. 12:3, and in others the leopard like beast of ch. 13:1, 2. The context makes the latter relationship appear to be closer. The chief difference between the beast of ch. 13 and that of ch. 17 is that in the former, which is identified with the papacy, no distinction is made between the religious and the political aspects of papal power, whereas in the latter the two are distinct—the beast representing political power and the woman, religious power.

Revelation 17: 4-6…Note the three colours that the Woman was wearing: **Purple, Scarlet** and **Gold!**

Exodus 28: 31-33…Here God gives specific instructions to Moses about how the priests were to dress. Everything was specific; it had to be a certain way!

Note: Many of us find the books of Exodus and Leviticus very tedious and boring to read/study. This is understandable as they are pretty much an instruction manual. The last half of Exodus and all of Leviticus is simply God giving very explicit instructions on how to conduct themselves in the Sanctuary; how to build the Sanctuary; how to dress in the Sanctuary and how to perform the rites and rituals in the Sanctuary.

Now, isn't that interesting? Look at the colours that the High priest was supposed to wear: **Purple, Scarlet, blue** and **gold**. So we find the woman of Revelation 17 is wearing all the colours of the High priest bar one! Blue is missing… Why? Because she has forgotten the Law and Commandments of God.

Now, think about it! The Law of God is taken from the very throne of God and then placed in the ark. Did you know that the ark was a symbol of the throne of God? On the Ark of the Covenant we have

two angels that where situated on either side of the mercy seat and above this mercy seat it was nothing other than the *Shechinah* Glory, which represented the presence of God himself!

So here, in the Most Holy place of Gods sanctuary is the mercy seat which represents Gods throne. What's under the throne? The tablets of stone made out of blue sapphire cut from the very throne of God!

Isaiah 14: 12-15…In light of this proud statement along with our understanding of the great controversy between God and Satan, is it unreasonable to assume that Satan will attempt to usurp Gods throne by setting up an apostate/counterfeit throne of his own through an earthly vicegerent?

Note this quotation by E. G. White:

"During the Christian dispensation, the great enemy of man's happiness has made the Sabbath of the fourth commandment an object of special attack. Satan says, "I will work at cross purposes with God. I will empower my followers to set aside God's memorial, the seventh-day Sabbath. Thus I will show the world that the day sanctified and blessed by God has been changed. That day shall not live in the minds of the people. I will obliterate the memory of it. I will place in its stead a day that does not bear the credentials of God, a day that cannot be a sign between God and His people. I will lead those who accept this day to place upon it the sanctity that God placed upon the seventh day. Through my vicegerent, I will exalt myself. The first day will be extolled, and the Protestant world will receive this spurious Sabbath as genuine. Through the non-observance of the Sabbath that God instituted, I will bring His law into contempt. The words, 'A sign between Me and you throughout your generations,' I will make to serve on the side of my Sabbath."

White, Ellen Gould: Conflict of the Ages Series, Volume 2; Prophets and Kings, chap 14, p 184.

Before we get hung up on the great debate over legalism and grace, it must be noted that people living in both the Old Testament and the New Testament times are **saved by grace and grace alone**! People that lived prior to Christ looked forward to the Cross of Calvary and we today look back to it! The law never had anything to do with salvation! So what is the purpose of the law? Simply this:

The Law is like a mirror, the law is designed to show us two things-number one, the righteousness of God and number two, the unrighteousness of man. Note what James says in the New Testament;

James 1: 22-25…When we look, into that perfect Law of liberty, we discover that we are all unrighteous.

Romans 3: 12; 23…As Paul so eloquently puts it, there is none who does good and we have all sinned.

The purpose of Gods Law is to show us how righteous he is and conversely how unrighteous we are, and then drive us to Jesus! Because we need a saviour to take away our unrighteousness and our sin.

We don't keep the Law of God in order to *be* saved! Remember salvation is only possible through the Blood of Christ, but rather Gods faithful followers keep Gods Commandments because they *are*

saved. Some people say that the Ten Commandments were nailed to the cross and were therefore abolished. Something was nailed to the cross but it was certainly not the Ten Commandments.

Think about it! Which one of the Ten should we get rid of? The one that says you should have no other Gods? The first one, or how about number two that says don't worship an image? What about number three that says we are not to take the Lords name in vain? Okay, how about number four that says remember the Sabbath day to keep it Holy? We don't need that do we? How about the one that says honour your father and mother? New Testament Christians shouldn't have to do that? Or what about the one that says don't kill? That's obviously for the Old Testament Church only? How about the one that says don't steal or commit adultery? I mean that's legalism isn't it? I might be sounding a little sarcastic but this is what the popular belief system is today….the Law has been done away with?

Matthew 5: 17-19…In unmistakable language Jesus testified to His regard for the law of Jehovah. "*Think not that I have come to destroy the law, or the prophets, I did not come to destroy, but to fulfil. For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled. Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.*"

The difference in the New Testament and the many problems that the apostles had to address was the miscomprehension of the purpose of the Law. For many of the preceding centuries, the Jewish understanding of the Law was an outward carnal obedience to its letter! They simply lost sight of the spirituality of the Law. Christians keep the Law not to be saved but because they are saved. The Law tells us that we need a saviour and drives us to Jesus, and Jesus by his grace saves us and cleanses us from all unrighteousness (1 John 1: 9).